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Education

- 2021–27* **Ph.D., Economics**, University of Massachusetts Amherst, USA
- Dissertation: *Three Essays on Outsourcing Social Reproduction in India*
 - Committee: James Heintz (Chair), Ina Ganguli, Nancy Folbre, Joya Misra (external)
 - Fields: Feminist Economics, Political Economy
- 2021–23 **M.A., Economics**, University of Massachusetts Amherst, USA
- 2017–19 **M.A., Economics**, Ambedkar University Delhi, India
- 2014–17 **B.A., Economics**, Miranda House, University of Delhi, India

*Expected.

Job Market Paper

Outsourcing Social Reproduction: Determinants and Consequences of Paid Domestic Work in Urban India [\[Link\]](#)

Hiring a paid domestic worker in urban India transfers part of the daily work of maintaining, feeding, and caring for household members across caste and class hierarchies. This domestic outsourcing has time consequences on both sides of the transaction, which have never been analyzed using a nationally representative dataset. This paper uses pooled data from the Pan-India Time Use Survey 2019 and 2024 to quantify the gendered impact of paid domestic labor for both employers and workers, separately for live-in and live-out arrangements. On the employer side, the gains accrue to women in households at the top of the caste and class order. Relative to non-outsourcing households, the presence of a live-in worker is associated with nearly twice the reduction in women's unpaid time and nearly three times the increase in their paid time observed under live-out arrangements, while men's time is largely unaffected. On the worker side, the length of the workday is similar for women and men within each arrangement, but among live-out workers, women spend nearly four times as much time on unpaid work as men. Taken together, this transaction places two women at its opposite ends, but their class and caste locations determine which one outsources it and which one takes it up.

Papers

Working Papers

Rajput, Hiya S. and M. V. Lee Badgett. "Exploring the Third Gender: Analyzing the Economic Position of Transgender Individuals in India." *Revise and Resubmit*, Feminist Economics (Special Issue on LGBTI+ Economic Development and Empowerment).

Kanougiya, Suman, Venkatesan Chakrapani, Ayden I. Scheim, M. V. Lee Badgett, and **Hiya S. Rajput**. "Dual Invisibility in Development Statistics: Time Use, Unpaid Work, and Economic Participation among Transgender Respondents in India."

Works in Progress

Rajput, Hiya S. “Social Reproduction on Call: The Gendered Economy of Live-in Domestic Work in India.”

Rajput, Hiya S. “Pushed, Not Pulled: The Rise of Own-Account and Domestic Work Among Less-Educated Urban Indian Women.”

Ganguli, Ina and **Hiya S. Rajput.** The effect of graduate student unionization on wages and degree completion at US universities.

Research Experience

- 2025–26 Research Assistant for Prof. James Heintz, [Political Economy Research Institute \(PERI\)](#), University of Massachusetts Amherst
- Reviewed and synthesized literature on social reproduction, informality, market power, and migrant remittances for working papers, with a focus on Global South political economy scholarship.
 - Assembled and processed National Transfer Accounts and National Time Transfer Accounts (NTA/NTTA) data from the Counting Women’s Work project.
- 2023–25 Research Assistant for Prof. Ina Ganguli, [Political Economy Research Institute](#), University of Massachusetts Amherst
- Helped build a novel dataset of graduate student contracts and wages at US universities through archival searches and public records (FOIA) requests.
 - Built an Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS) institution-year panel of doctoral completions; helped implement an event-study analysis of contract effects (Python, Stata).

Teaching Experience***Teaching Assistant, University of Massachusetts Amherst***

- Spring 2023 ECON 309: Game Theory
- Fall 2022 ECON 452: Econometrics (Stata lab)
- 2021–22 ECON 103: Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2021, Spring 2022)

Instructor, University of Massachusetts Amherst

- Summer 2022 Graduate Math Camp

Professional Experience

- 2020–21 Research Associate, [Institute for What Works to Advance Gender Equality \(IWWAGE\)](#), New Delhi, India
- Analyzed primary data and assisted in writing *India’s Emerging Gig Economy: The Future of Work for Women Workers* for [The Asia Foundation](#).
 - Contributed to an evaluation of Aajeevika Grameen Express Yojana (AGEY), a rural transport scheme under the Ministry of Rural Development.
- 2019–20 Research Assistant, [Institute for What Works to Advance Gender Equality](#), New Delhi, India
- Co-authored *Women’s Workforce Participation in India: Statewise Trends* for [Madhya Pradesh](#) and [Bihar](#).

- Wrote the blog post “[Empowering Women in the Economy: Addressing Gaps and Rethinking the Discourse](#)”, drawing on the discussions at [The 61st Indian Society of Labour Economics \(ISLE\) Conference](#).

Conferences and Presentations

2026	34th IAFFE Annual Conference, Cali, Colombia <i>Paid Domestic Work and Household Time Allocation: Evidence from India</i>
2025	33rd IAFFE Annual Conference, Amherst, MA, USA <i>Exploring the Third Gender: Analyzing the Economic Position of Transgender Individuals in India</i>
2024	IAFFE Special Issue Workshop, Rome, Italy <i>Exploring the Third Gender: Analyzing the Economic Position of Transgender Individuals in India</i>
2019	61st Annual Conference of the Indian Society of Labour Economics (ISLE), Patiala, India <i>Rapporteur</i>

Honors and Awards

2026	Dissertation Fellowship, Political Economy Research Institute
2025	Chair’s Joint Summer Research Fellowship (with Prof. Ina Ganguli)
2023	Special Issue Fund, International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE)
2023	Chair’s Joint Summer Research Fellowship (with Prof. Lee Badgett)
2018	UGC-NET Certification for Assistant Professor in Economics, University Grants Commission, India

Skills

Software	Stata, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, NVivo (basic)
Languages	English, Hindi

Professional Affiliations

Member at International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE)

References

James Heintz (Chair)

Andrew Glyn Professor of Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
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Ina Ganguli

Professor, Department of Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
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Nancy Folbre

Director, Program on Gender and Care Work
Political Economy Research Institute
Professor Emerita of Economics
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Lee Badgett

Chief Economist and Founding Partner
Koppa – The LGBTI+ Economic Power Lab
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